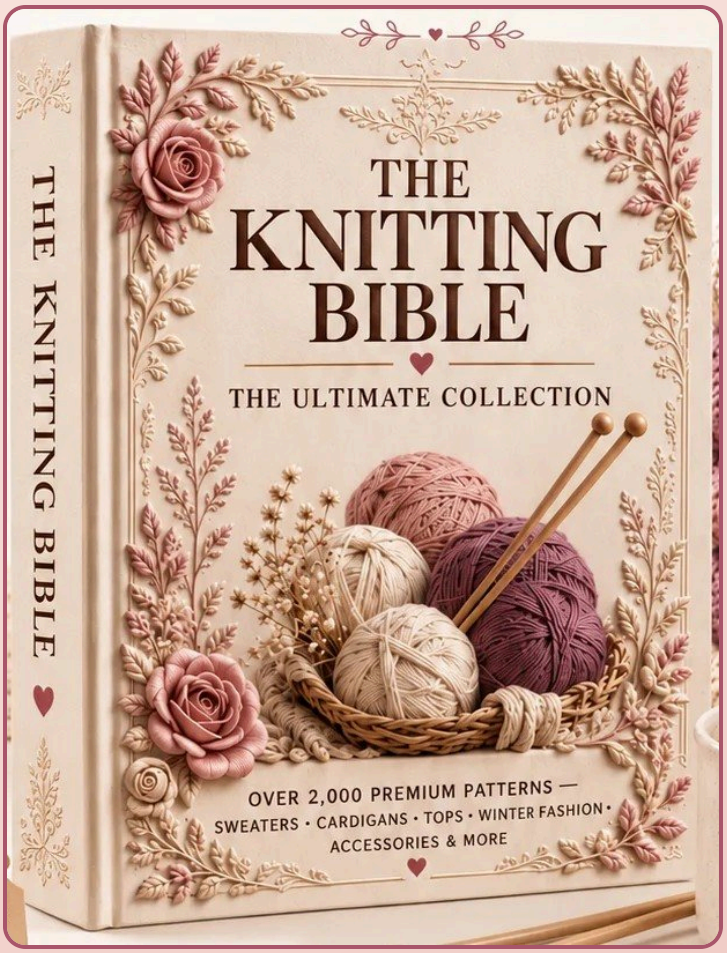
BONUS 5

The Art of Macrame

Knotting techniques for beautiful home decor



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> *Macrame is the craft of making fabric, texture and shape from nothing but knots. There is no loom, no needle and no chart to decode. You need cord, a few simple knots and a little patience. This guide teaches you every knot you need, step by step, then takes you through twelve complete projects: from a keychain you can finish in an evening to a large boho wall hanging that will become the centerpiece of a room. If you already knit or crochet, you will find that macrame builds on the same skills: even tension, careful counting, and the quiet pleasure of repeating a pattern until it grows under your hands.*

1. Welcome to Macrame

Macrame (say it mack-ruh-MAY) is knotting with cord. Every piece in this guide is made from just a handful of knots, combined in different ways. Once your hands know the square knot and the clove hitch, you can read almost any macrame design you see, and you will start to notice how many pieces in shops and magazines are built from the same few moves.

This bonus is organized so you can learn in order. First you will gather your materials and set up a comfortable workspace. Then you will practice each knot on scrap cord. Finally, you will make twelve projects, from the quickest to the most ambitious. Each project lists the cord thickness, the number of cords to cut, the exact length of each cord, the finished size and numbered steps, so you can check the numbers before you cut anything.

Do not worry about perfect results at the start. Macrame is forgiving: almost every knot can be untied and retied, and a slightly uneven row becomes part of the handmade charm. What matters most is steady, even tension, and you will build that with every row you tie.

> **How to use this guide**
>
> Practice every knot in section 4 on scrap cord before you start a project. Ten minutes of practice saves hours of untying later. Work the projects in the order given if you are new to macrame: they get gradually more demanding.

> **Safety first**
>
> Scissors must be sharp and used with care: always cut away from your body and your fingers, and store them closed. Macrame pieces that hang on a wall, ceiling or door carry real weight. Always check the load capacity of the hook, anchor or rod, fasten it into a wall stud or a proper anchor, and hang heavy items securely. Plants must be hung securely, never above seating areas, beds or cribs. Beads, rings and small decorations are choking hazards: do not leave small projects within reach of young children or pets without supervision.

2. Materials and Tools

Cord types

The cord you choose changes the look of the piece more than any other decision. Here are the main types:

- **Single-strand twisted cotton cord:** soft, easy to knot, and easy to unravel into a fluffy fringe. It is the best choice for wall hangings and feathers, but it can stretch under heavy loads.

- **Three-ply twisted cotton rope:** three strands twisted together. It is firm, holds its shape and gives clear knot definition. A good all-round choice for plant hangers, shelves and runners.
- **Braided cotton cord:** smooth and strong, with no fluff. It keeps knots very crisp and is a good choice for curtain tiebacks and keychains because it resists fraying and wear.
- **Jute and hemp:** natural, rustic and rough on the hands. Strong and good for plant hangers. Soften jute by rolling it between your palms before you start.
- **Polyester or nylon cord:** very strong and weatherproof. Good for outdoor pieces and for bracelets and necklaces, because it does not absorb water. It slips more than cotton, so knots need to be pulled snug.
- **Recycled cotton cord:** made from fabric scraps, soft and slightly speckled. Lovely for a relaxed, natural look.

Cord thickness by project

Cord thickness is measured in millimeters (mm). One inch is about 25 mm, so a 3 mm cord is a little over 1/8 inch thick and a 5 mm cord is about 3/16 inch. Thicker cord gives bolder knots and works up faster, but needs more length. Thinner cord gives finer detail.

PROJECT	CORD THICKNESS	WHY THIS THICKNESS
Bracelet	1.5 mm	Fine and comfortable against the skin
Necklace	2 mm	Delicate, still strong enough to carry a bead
Keychain	3 mm	Sturdy enough for daily use
Coaster	3 mm	Flat, dense surface that holds a cup
Small wall hanging	3 mm	Fine detail on a small piece
Feather	3 mm	Soft cord that brushes out into fluffy fibers
Plant hanger	4 mm	Strong enough for a pot, still easy to knot
Table runner	4 mm	Good drape with a firm surface
Curtain tieback	4 mm	Holds its shape when wrapped around fabric
Mirror hanger	4 mm	Strong enough for a light mirror
Large boho wall hanging	5 mm	Bold, chunky knots visible from across the room
Hanging shelf	5 mm	Strength for a small shelf and its contents

Dowels, rings and other supports

- **Wooden dowels:** 3/8 to 1/2 inch (10 to 12 mm) thick, cut longer than your piece is wide. Driftwood branches also work, as long as they are clean, dry and free of bark.
- **Wooden or metal rings:** 1.5 to 3 inches (4 to 8 cm) across, used as the top of plant hangers, keychains and mirror hangers. Choose rings that are smooth with no sharp edges.

- **Beads:** wooden beads with a hole at least 1 mm bigger than your cord. Keep them away from small children and pets.
- **Sharp fabric scissors:** keep them only for cord. Dull scissors crush cord and give uneven, messy ends.
- **Measuring tape or ruler:** for cutting cord and checking sizes. A hard ruler is useful for straight fringe.
- **Drying rack, clipboard or foam board:** something you can clip or pin your work to so it stays still while you knot.
- **Wide-toothed comb or pet brush:** for brushing out fringe.
- **Clips, pins and masking tape:** to hold cord ends and keep cords from tangling.
- **Tapestry needle:** for tucking in loose ends on flat pieces.

How much cord to cut: the 4x to 8x rule

Knots eat cord. A cord that looks long enough on the table can disappear into a few rows of knots. The rule that makes it easy is to multiply the length you want the finished piece to measure (including the fringe) by a number from 4 to 8, depending on how much knotting the piece has. The result is the cut length of each cord, before you fold it.

MULTIPLIER	USE IT FOR	EXAMPLE: FINISHED LENGTH 20 IN
4x	Lots of open space, a few knots, simple wrapping and plain lark's head hangs	20 x 4 = 80 in
6x	Square knot chains and alternating square knot patterns	20 x 6 = 120 in
8x	Dense knotting: half knot spirals, many rows of clove hitches, chunky cord	20 x 8 = 160 in

There is a quick way to think about it: the cords that do the knotting (the working cords) use most of the length. The cords that stay straight in the middle of a square knot (the filler cords) use much less. In this guide every cord in a piece is cut to the same length for simplicity, so you can fold, hang and go. If you want to save cord, you can cut the filler cords shorter, but plan carefully before you do.

The table below applies the rule to every project: finished length times the multiplier equals the cut length per cord. Hanging, mounting and wrapping cords are added in the total, as each project explains.

PROJECT	FINISHED LENGTH (IN)	MULTIPLIER	CUT LENGTH PER CORD (IN)	NUMBER OF CORDS	TOTAL CORD (YARDS, ROUNDED UP)
Keychain	6	6x	36	2	2
Coaster	4	6x	24	12	9
Small wall hanging	16	6x	96	12	33
Large boho wall hanging	27	8x	216	16	97

PROJECT	FINISHED LENGTH (IN)	MULTIPLIER	CUT LENGTH PER CORD (IN)	NUMBER OF CORDS	TOTAL CORD (YARDS, ROUNDED UP)
Plant hanger	36	4x	144	6	26
Hanging shelf	36	4x	144	8	34
Table runner	30	6x	180	16	81
Curtain tieback	18	8x	144	2	8
Mirror hanger	18	6x	108	4	13
Bracelet	6 (knotted)	6x	36 working, 16 filler	2 + 2	3
Necklace	3 (knotted)	6x	18 working, 30 filler	2 + 2	3
Feather	6	4x	24	6 + 1 holding cord	5

One yard equals 36 inches, and one meter is about 39 inches. The yardage totals above include hanging, mounting and wrapping cords where the project calls for them. Buy about 10 percent more cord than the total to allow for mistakes and trimming.

> **Buy once, buy enough**
>
> Dye lots can differ slightly between skeins. If you plan a large project, buy all the cord you need in one purchase. Keep a few extra yards for repairs.

3. Setting Up Your Workspace

A good setup keeps cords from tangling and your hands relaxed. You will be repeating the same small movements hundreds of times, so comfort matters.

- **Choose a hanging point at chest height.** A wall hook, a sturdy rod between two chairs, or a clothes drying rack all work. Your hands should rest at about chest level so your shoulders stay relaxed. Make sure whatever you hang from is stable and cannot tip over.
- **Use a work surface for small items.** Keychains, bracelets and necklaces are easiest on a clipboard or foam board with the top held under a clip.
- **Good light.** Natural, even light lets you see the texture of the cord and avoid mistakes.
- **Keep a clear floor.** Long cords will pool on the floor. Wrap them into small butterfly bundles (loop the cord around your fingers and tie a loose wrap around the middle) to keep them tidy.
- **Keep scissors, tape and a pencil within reach** but off the floor, away from children and pets.

> **Take breaks**
>
> Macrame is gentle on the body, but repeating the same motion can tire the hands and shoulders. Stop every 30 to 45 minutes, stretch your hands and roll your shoulders. If anything hurts, take a longer break.

4. Mounting and Knotting Techniques

Every knot below is described as a series of numbered steps. Read them once, then practice with a piece of scrap cord at least 1 yard long. Use two contrasting colors if you can: it is much easier to see what each strand is doing.

Lark's head knot

The lark's head knot attaches a folded cord to a dowel, ring or another cord. It is the starting point for almost every project.

1. Fold the cord in half to make a loop at the fold.
2. Lay the loop over the front of the dowel, with the loop pointing down.
3. Bring the loop behind the dowel and pull it up toward you, so the dowel now has a loop hanging at the back.
4. Pass both loose ends through the loop from front to back.
5. Pull both ends down firmly to tighten. The knot should sit snug on the dowel with a small bump at the top.

- **Common mistake:** pulling only one tail. Always pull both tails evenly so the knot does not twist or tip sideways.
- **Common mistake:** letting the knots slide. Space them evenly and push them close together before you tighten.

Reverse lark's head knot

The reverse version has the knot bump on the front rather than the back. It looks neat and is useful for a dowel that will be visible from both sides.

1. Fold the cord in half and hold the loop at the fold.
2. Place the loop behind the dowel so that it points down at the back.
3. Bring the loop forward and over the top of the dowel, so it hangs down on the front.
4. Pass both loose ends behind the dowel and up through the loop from back to front.
5. Pull both ends down to tighten. The bump now sits at the front of the dowel.

- **Common mistake:** mixing standard and reverse lark's heads in one row. Pick one style and keep it for the whole row.

Clove hitch (horizontal)

The clove hitch wraps one cord around another to form a ridge. Done in a row, it creates a firm horizontal line that looks like a rib.

1. Hold the cord that will form the line (the holding cord) tight, straight across your work, from left to right.
2. Take the first working cord and bring it over the holding cord from front to back.
3. Wrap it around the holding cord and bring it back to the front, crossing over its own first wrap.

4. Wrap it around the holding cord a second time, and then tuck the end under the diagonal crossing you made in step 3.
5. Pull the working cord down firmly. You have made one clove hitch.
6. Repeat steps 2 to 5 with each cord in turn, always working over the same holding cord.

- **Common mistake:** letting the holding cord go slack. Hold it taut with your free hand or pin the end.
- **Common mistake:** uneven tension between hitches. Pull each hitch the same amount for a straight line.

Clove hitch (diagonal)

The diagonal clove hitch is made exactly like the horizontal one, but the holding cord is held at an angle, usually 45 degrees. It makes diagonal lines and is the basis of feathers and chevron patterns.

1. Take the leftmost cord and hold it tight, angled down to the right at about 45 degrees. This is the holding cord.
2. Take the next cord to its right and tie a clove hitch around the holding cord, following steps 2 to 5 of the horizontal clove hitch.
3. Pull it tight along the diagonal line.
4. Repeat with each cord in turn, from left to right, using the same holding cord.
5. When the row is finished, the holding cord is the last cord on the right.

- **Common mistake:** letting the angle drift. Pin the end of the holding cord to your board at the angle you want.
- **Common mistake:** forgetting that the holding cord ends up at the opposite side. Count your cords at the end of each row.

Clove hitch (vertical)

In a vertical clove hitch, you tie hitches down a cord that hangs straight down, which makes a neat vertical ridge.

1. Hold one cord straight down as the holding cord and clip its bottom end so it stays taut.
2. Take a working cord and bring it across the holding cord from the left, in front.
3. Wrap it around the holding cord and cross over its own first wrap, as in the horizontal clove hitch.
4. Wrap once more and tuck the end under the crossing. Pull it snug.
5. Repeat with the same working cord down the holding cord, spacing the hitches as you wish.

- **Common mistake:** twisting the holding cord. Keep it straight with a clip at the bottom.

Square knot

The square knot is the most important knot in macrame. It uses four strands: two outer cords (the working cords) and two center cords (the filler cords). The working cords tie around the filler cords. Call the strands A, B, C and D from left to right. B and C are the fillers.

1. Lay out the four cords side by side, with A and D slightly longer than B and C.

2. Take cord A and cross it over B and C, so it lies on the right. It now forms a loop shape, like the number 4, with D.
3. Take cord D and pass it behind C and B. Bring it out on the left, through the loop that A made.
4. Pull A and D outward, away from the fillers, to tighten. This is the first half of the knot.
5. Now repeat the process in the opposite direction. Take cord D (which is now on the left) and cross it over B and C to the right.
6. Take cord A (now on the right) and pass it behind C and B, then bring it out on the left through the loop made by D.
7. Pull both outer cords outward to tighten. You have completed one square knot, and the working cords are back where they started.

- **Common mistake:** not alternating the direction. If you repeat the same half again and again, you make a spiral instead (see half knot spiral below).
- **Common mistake:** tightening onto the fillers. Pull the working cords outward, not down, and keep the fillers straight.
- **Common mistake:** crossed filler cords. Keep B and C parallel through the whole knot.

Alternating square knot

The alternating square knot is the classic macrame net. You tie a row of square knots, then a second row in which each knot uses two cords from the neighboring knots. The result is a diamond pattern.

1. Hang the cords in groups of four. Tie a square knot with each group in the first row.
2. For the second row, skip the first two cords on the left and the last two cords on the right.
3. Take the next four cords, starting with the third, and tie a square knot. These four cords include two cords from the knot on the left and two from the knot on the right.
4. Continue across the row, tying a square knot with each new group of four.
5. Start the third row like the first: tie square knots with the original groups.
6. Alternate rows to build up the pattern. Keep a small gap of about 1/4 inch (6 mm) between rows for a lacy net, or no gap for a dense fabric.

- **Common mistake:** forgetting to leave the end cords free in the offset rows. They hang untouched, then are picked up again in the next row.
- **Common mistake:** uneven spacing. Use a ruler to check the distance between rows.

Half knot spiral

When you repeat only the first half of the square knot over and over, the knot twists naturally into a spiral. This is the half knot spiral, used in curtain tiebacks, hair accessories and decorative cords.

1. Use four cords, with two filler cords in the center and one working cord on each side.
2. Tie the first half of a square knot: left cord over the fillers, right cord behind them and out through the loop on the left.
3. Tighten by pulling the working cords outward.

4. Tie the same half again, always starting with the same side. Do not alternate.
5. After about 8 knots you will see the spiral start to twist. Keep going, tightening each knot against the one before.
6. Rotate the work as it twists so the knots stay facing you.

- **Common mistake:** accidentally alternating one knot, which breaks the spiral. If you see a straight section, undo back to it.
- **Common mistake:** knots too loose. A tight spiral looks sleek; a loose one looks messy.

Double half hitch

The double half hitch is two half hitches tied one after the other around a cord. It is used to attach cords to a ring, to a dowel, or to start a row in a pattern.

1. Hold the holding cord taut.
2. Bring the working cord over the holding cord and then under it, forming a loop around it.
3. Pass the end of the working cord through the loop and pull it tight. This is the first half hitch.
4. Repeat steps 2 and 3 in the same direction to make the second half hitch.
5. Pull firmly. The two half hitches should sit side by side.

- **Common mistake:** reversing direction between the two half hitches, which creates a different knot that can slip. Make both turns the same way.

Gathering knot (wrapping knot)

The gathering knot wraps a small cord around a bundle of cords to hold them together neatly. It is used at the top of plant hangers and at the base of tassels.

1. Cut a wrapping cord about 30 inches (75 cm) long.
2. Make a loop with the wrapping cord, laying it along the bundle with the loop pointing down and the short tail pointing up.
3. Hold the loop in place with your thumb and wrap the long end tightly around both the bundle and the loop, moving upward. Make 5 to 8 wraps for a neat finish.
4. Pass the end of the cord through the loop at the top of the wraps.
5. Pull the bottom tail to draw the loop and the end up under the wraps and hide them.
6. Trim both tails flush with the wraps.

- **Common mistake:** wraps that overlap. Lay each wrap right next to the last.
- **Common mistake:** loose wraps. Pull each one firmly as you go.

Overhand knot

The overhand knot is a simple knot used for stoppers, bead holders and closures.

1. Make a loop in the cord.

2. Pass the end of the cord through the loop from front to back.
3. Pull both ends to tighten. For a bigger stopper, make a double overhand by passing through twice before tightening.

- **Common mistake:** pulling too fast. Tighten gently, adjusting the knot's position as you go.

Finishing: trimming, brushing and combing fringe

Fringe is the finishing touch that makes macrame look soft and professional.

1. Decide on the fringe length and the shape: straight, V-shaped (shorter in the middle), or angled.
2. Mark the cut line with a ruler or by folding the piece in half.
3. Cut the cords with sharp scissors in one clean snip each. Cut straight across, or at a gentle angle.
4. Untwist each cord with your fingers or a needle, working from the bottom up.
5. Comb or brush out the fibers with a wide-toothed comb or a pet brush, holding the cord just above the area you are brushing so you do not pull the knot loose.
6. Trim any long fibers to even the edge.

> **Cut slowly and carefully**
> Cut one or two cords at a time, away from your body. Once cut, the fringe cannot be lengthened, so trim a little less than you think you need and adjust.

5. Twelve Complete Projects

Each project below lists the cord thickness, number of cords, cut length for each cord, finished size and steps. All cut lengths follow the rule from section 2. Cut your cords first, label them if needed, and keep the leftover ends for practice.

When a project says to fold the cords in half and attach them with lark's head knots, each cut cord becomes two hanging strands. For example, 12 cords give 24 strands, which is 6 square knots across (24 / 4 = 6).

Project 1: Keychain

A small, practical first project: a chain of square knots on a ring. It takes about 30 minutes and uses only 2 yards of cord.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	3 mm braided or twisted cotton
Cords to cut	2
Length of each cord	36 in (91 cm), which is 6 in finished x 6
Working strands	4 (2 cords folded in half)
Other	1 key ring, 1.5 in (4 cm), plus one bead with a hole of 4 mm (optional)

ITEM	DETAILS
Finished size	About 6 in (15 cm) long, including fringe
Total cord	72 in (2 yd)

1. Fold both cords in half and attach them to the key ring with lark's head knots, side by side. You now have 4 strands hanging, each 18 in long.
2. Arrange the strands with the two center strands as fillers and the outer strands as the working cords.
3. Tie a square knot about 1 in (2.5 cm) below the ring, tightening it firmly.
4. Keep tying square knots, one directly below the other, until the chain is 3 in (7.5 cm) long. At 3/4 in (2 cm) per knot, you need about 4 knots; check the length as you go.
5. Optional: slide a bead onto the two filler strands, then finish with one more square knot to lock it in place.
6. Tie an overhand knot with all four strands together, snug under the last square knot.
7. Trim the ends to about 2 in (5 cm) below the overhand knot, then untwist and brush out the fringe.

> **Keep it small and safe**
>
> Beads are a choking hazard. Do not leave a keychain with a bead where small children or pets can reach it, and check the knots before every use.

Project 2: Coaster

A flat, square coaster made of alternating square knots. It needs good tension, so go slowly.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	3 mm cotton cord
Cords to cut	12
Length of each cord	24 in (61 cm), which is 4 in finished x 6
Working strands	24 (12 cords folded in half)
Other	1 scrap cord of 8 in (20 cm) as a temporary mounting cord, tapestry needle
Finished size	About 4 x 4 in (10 x 10 cm)
Total cord	296 in including the mounting cord (9 yd)

1. Tie the mounting cord between two pins or clips on your board, about 6 in (15 cm) apart.
2. Fold each of the 12 cords in half and attach them to the mounting cord with lark's head knots, side by side. You have 24 strands.
3. Row 1: group the strands in sets of 4 and tie 6 square knots across (6 x 4 = 24 strands).
4. Row 2: leave the first 2 and last 2 strands free. Tie 5 square knots with the 20 strands in between (5 x 4 = 20).

5. Row 3: tie 6 square knots like row 1. Row 4: tie 5 square knots like row 2. Continue alternating until you have worked 8 rows in total.
6. Slide the mounting cord out. The folded loops stay in place and form a neat edge.
7. Turn the coaster over. Thread each loose end on the back with a tapestry needle through two or three knots, then trim flush.
8. Press the coaster flat under a heavy book for an hour to even out the edges.

> **Care**
>
> Handwash the coaster in lukewarm water with mild soap when stained, and lay it flat to dry. Do not use it under a hot pot or a very hot pan.

Project 3: Small Wall Hanging

A gentle introduction to wall decor: square knots, a row of clove hitches and a straight fringe.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	3 mm cotton cord
Cords to cut	12, plus 1 hanging cord of 36 in (91 cm)
Length of each cord	96 in (2.7 yd), which is 16 in finished x 6
Working strands	24 (12 cords folded in half)
Other	1 wooden dowel, 6 in (15 cm) long and 3/8 in (10 mm) thick
Finished size	About 4.5 in wide x 16 in long (11 x 41 cm), plus the dowel
Total cord	1188 in (33 yd)

1. Tie the hanging cord to the ends of the dowel with overhand knots, leaving a loop to hang it from. Check that it is level.
2. Fold each of the 12 cords in half and attach them to the dowel with lark's head knots, side by side. You now have 24 strands.
3. Row 1: tie 6 square knots across (6 x 4 = 24 strands).
4. Row 2: skip the first 2 and last 2 strands and tie 5 square knots (5 x 4 = 20 strands).
5. Row 3: tie 6 square knots. Row 4: tie 5 square knots.
6. Row 5: tie 6 square knots. You have built 5 rows.
7. Make a horizontal clove hitch line: take the leftmost strand as the holding cord, pull it across to the right and tie each of the other 23 strands around it in turn.
8. Work 2 more rows of alternating square knots (one with 5 knots, one with 6).
9. Trim the fringe in a V shape, with the shortest cords at the center, leaving 5 to 6 in (13 to 15 cm) at the sides.
10. Brush out the fringe and hang on a secure hook.

Hanging

Even small hangings need a proper hook. Use a hook rated for well above the piece's weight and fasten it to a wall stud or with a wall anchor.

Project 4: Large Boho Wall Hanging

A statement piece: a mix of square knots, spirals and a long fringe, worked in chunky cord.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	5 mm cotton rope
Cords to cut	16, plus 1 hanging cord of 36 in (91 cm)
Length of each cord	216 in (6 yd), which is 27 in finished x 8
Working strands	32 (16 cords folded in half)
Other	1 wooden dowel, 14 in (36 cm) long and 1/2 in (12 mm) thick
Finished size	About 9 in wide x 27 in long (23 x 69 cm), plus the dowel
Total cord	3492 in (97 yd)

1. Tie the hanging cord to the dowel and hang it at chest height.
2. Fold the 16 cords in half and attach them with lark's head knots. You now have 32 strands.
3. Row 1: tie 8 square knots across (8 x 4 = 32 strands).
4. Row 2: skip the first 2 and last 2 strands and tie 7 square knots (7 x 4 = 28 strands).
5. Rows 3 and 4: repeat rows 1 and 2 to form a net of diamonds.
6. Divide the 32 strands into 8 groups of 4. In each group, use the 2 center strands as fillers and tie a half knot spiral of 12 half knots.
7. Below the spirals, work 2 rows of alternating square knots over all 32 strands (8 knots, then 7 knots).
8. Make a diagonal clove hitch line from each side down to the center, forming a V, using the outermost strand on each side as the holding cord.
9. Finish with one more row of 8 square knots.
10. Mark the fringe at 8 in (20 cm) below the last row, trim in a V shape, then untwist and brush out the fringe.

Weight

A piece this size can weigh several pounds. Hang it from a hook rated well above its weight, anchored into a wall stud, and check that the dowel cannot slide off the cord.

Project 5: Plant Hanger (3 plus 1)

A hanger with three legs. In each leg, 3 strands do the holding and 1 strand wraps around them: that is the 3 plus 1 pattern.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	4 mm cotton or jute cord
Cords to cut	6, plus 1 wrapping cord of 40 in (102 cm)
Length of each cord	144 in (4 yd), which is 36 in finished x 4
Strands	12 (6 cords folded in half), grouped as 3 legs of 4 strands
Other	1 wooden or metal ring, 2.5 in (6 cm)
Finished size	About 36 in long (91 cm), for a pot up to 6 in (15 cm) wide
Total cord	904 in (26 yd)

1. Fold the 6 cords in half and attach them to the ring with lark's head knots. You now have 12 strands.
2. Gather the 12 strands just below the ring and wrap them tightly with the 40 in wrapping cord, 6 wraps long, using the gathering knot.
3. Divide the 12 strands into 3 legs of 4 strands each.
4. In each leg, use 3 strands as the holding strands and 1 strand as the wrapper (this is the 3 plus 1). Wrap the single strand tightly around the other 3 for 2 in (5 cm), then tuck its end through the wraps to secure it.
5. Below the wraps, tie a chain of 5 square knots in each leg, using the same 4 strands.
6. Measure 8 in (20 cm) down from the last knot of each leg. Take 2 strands from one leg and 2 from the neighboring leg and tie a square knot. Repeat all the way around to make three joins (3 x 4 = 12 strands).
7. Measure another 5 in (13 cm) down and repeat the cross-leg joins to make a second ring of knots.
8. Below the second ring, gather all 12 strands and wrap them with a gathering knot (use a spare piece of cord if needed).
9. Trim the tail to 6 in (15 cm), brush out the fringe, and check that the pot sits in the basket without sliding.

> **Hang plants safely**
>
> Hang the plant hanger from a ceiling hook rated for well above the weight of the wet pot and soil. Never hang it above a bed, a crib or a seating area. Wet soil and a full pot can weigh several pounds, so check the hook and the cord before each use.

Project 6: Hanging Shelf

A small wooden board suspended by knotted cords, ideal for a small plant or a few light decorative items.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	5 mm cotton rope
Cords to cut	8, plus 1 wrapping cord of 40 in (102 cm)
Length of each cord	144 in (4 yd), which is 36 in finished x 4

ITEM	DETAILS
Other	1 wooden board, 20 x 6 x 3/4 in (50 x 15 x 2 cm), with four 1/2 in holes drilled 1 in from each corner; 1 ring, 3 in (8 cm)
Finished size	20 in wide board, hanging 36 in (91 cm) from the ring
Total cord	1192 in (34 yd)

1. Sand the board so the holes and edges are smooth. Have a person with experience drill the holes if you are not used to a drill.
2. Take 2 cords together for each hole (4 holes x 2 cords = 8 cords). Fold each pair in half, pass the folded loop up through the hole, and pull the ends through the loop to anchor it on the underside; then tie an overhand knot with all the strands at the bottom as a stopper. Repeat for the other 3 holes.
3. Bring the 4 legs up and gather them at the ring, leaving the board level.
4. Tie a gathering knot with the 40 in wrapping cord just under the ring and secure it firmly.
5. In each leg, twist the strands together lightly and tie an overhand knot every 8 in (20 cm) as decoration.
6. Check the board is level. Adjust the stoppers by retying if needed.
7. Trim the ends above the knots at the top and brush out the fringe.

> **Check the load**
>
> Keep the shelf for light items only, under 5 lb (2.3 kg) unless your cord and hook say otherwise. Test it by hanging it low and adding the load gradually. Use a hook with a load rating well above the weight and anchor it into a stud. Never put anything with an open flame on it.

Project 7: Table Runner

A flat runner of alternating square knots, with a fringe on both ends. It takes patience but little skill.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	4 mm cotton cord
Cords to cut	16
Length of each cord	180 in (5 yd), which is 30 in finished x 6
Working strands	32 (16 cords folded in half)
Other	1 scrap cord of 12 in (30 cm) as a temporary mounting cord
Finished size	About 6 x 30 in (15 x 76 cm)
Total cord	2892 in (81 yd)

1. Tie the mounting cord between two pins on your board, and attach the 16 cords with lark's head knots. You have 32 strands.
2. Row 1: tie 8 square knots across (8 x 4 = 32 strands).

3. Row 2: skip the first 2 and last 2 strands and tie 7 square knots (7 x 4 = 28).
4. Continue alternating rows of 8 and 7 knots until the knotted section is 24 in (61 cm) long.
5. Slide the mounting cord out. The folded loops remain as a loop fringe at the top end.
6. Cut the loops open with sharp scissors if you want a straight fringe at both ends. Cut one loop at a time.
7. Trim both fringes to 3 in (7.5 cm), so the total length is 24 + 3 + 3 = 30 in. Untwist, comb and trim the edges.

> **Care**
> Wash the runner by hand in cool water. Do not wring. Lay flat to dry and comb the fringe afterward.

Project 8: Curtain Tieback

A twisted rope of half knots to hold back a curtain, with a ring at one end and a tassel at the other.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	4 mm braided cotton cord
Cords to cut	2
Length of each cord	144 in (4 yd), which is 18 in finished x 8
Working strands	4 (2 cords folded in half)
Other	1 wooden ring, 1.5 in (4 cm)
Finished size	18 in (46 cm) long, with a 4 in (10 cm) tassel
Total cord	288 in (8 yd)

1. Fold both cords in half and attach them to the ring with lark's head knots side by side. You have 4 strands.
2. Use the 2 middle strands as the fillers and the 2 outer strands as the working cords. Tie half knots, always starting from the same side, to create a spiral.
3. Continue until the spiral measures 14 in (36 cm), so that with the tassel the piece is 18 in (46 cm).
4. Tie a gathering knot around all four strands to secure the end.
5. Trim the ends to 4 in (10 cm) below the gathering knot to form a tassel. Untwist and brush out the fibers.
6. Wrap the tieback around the curtain and slide the tassel through the ring to hold it in place.

> **Safety**
> Do not use the tieback where a small child can reach it. Cords near curtains and blinds can be a strangling hazard for small children and pets.

Project 9: Bracelet

A slim square knot bracelet with a sliding closure. It is quick, light and easy to resize.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	1.5 mm waxed polyester or cotton cord
Cords to cut	2 working cords and 2 filler cords
Length	Working cords: 36 in (91 cm) each, which is 6 in finished x 6. Filler cords: 16 in (41 cm) each
Finished size	6 in (15 cm) knotted panel, adjustable from 6.5 to 9 in (16 to 23 cm)
Total cord	104 in (3 yd)

1. Tape the 2 filler cords side by side to your board. Lay one working cord on each side of them, with 4 in (10 cm) of filler cord free at the top.
2. Tie one overhand knot around all four cords at that point to hold them together, and tape the knot down.
3. Tie a square knot with the working cords around the fillers. Repeat until the panel is 6 in (15 cm) long. With 1.5 mm cord each knot is about 1/4 in (6 mm), so you need about 24 knots.
4. Tie an overhand knot with all four cords, tight against the last square knot. Trim the working cord tails close to the knot.
5. To make the closure, bring the two ends of the filler cords toward each other, overlapping the tails. With the tails of one end, tie a double overhand knot around the tails of the other end. Repeat with the second end around the first.
6. Pull the tails in opposite directions to slide the knots and adjust the size.
7. Trim the tails to 1 in (2.5 cm) and tie an overhand knot at each end to stop the knots slipping off.

> **Fit and safety**
>
> Make the bracelet loose enough to slide off if it gets caught. Keep it away from small children, who might chew or swallow it.

Project 10: Necklace

A delicate pendant necklace with a small bead held in a cradle of square knots.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	2 mm cotton or polyester cord
Cords to cut	2 working cords and 2 filler cords
Length	Working cords: 18 in (46 cm) each, which is 3 in finished x 6. Filler cords: 30 in (76 cm) each
Other	1 wooden bead, 10 mm, with a hole of at least 3 mm
Finished size	3 in (7.5 cm) knotted panel; adjustable from about 16 to 28 in (41 to 71 cm) around
Total cord	96 in (3 yd)

1. Tape the 2 filler cords side by side at the center of their length, and lay one working cord on each side of them.
2. Tie an overhand knot around all four cords at the center to start, and tape the knot down.
3. Tie 4 square knots, tightening each one.
4. Slide the bead onto the 2 filler cords so that it sits against the last knot.
5. Tie 4 more square knots below the bead to hold it in place.
6. Tie an overhand knot with all four cords under the last knot and trim the working cord tails close.
7. Make a sliding closure as in the bracelet: bring the two filler ends together, overlap the tails and tie a double overhand knot with each end around the other.
8. Slide the closure to adjust the length, then trim the tails and tie an overhand knot at each end.

> **Wear safely**
>
> Keep the necklace adjustable so it can slide off if caught. Do not give a necklace to a baby or toddler, and do not wear it while sleeping.

Project 11: Feather

A small feather decoration made of diagonal clove hitches. It is perfect to hang on a wall or to add to a gift.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	3 mm single-strand cotton cord
Cords to cut	6 for the feather, plus 1 holding cord of 12 in (30 cm)
Length of each cord	24 in (61 cm), which is 6 in finished x 4
Working strands	12 (6 cords folded in half), 6 on each side
Finished size	About 6 in (15 cm) long and 2.5 in (6 cm) wide
Total cord	156 in (5 yd)

1. Pin the 12 in holding cord horizontally on your board.
2. Fold each of the 6 cords in half and attach them to the holding cord with lark's head knots, side by side. You now have 12 strands, 6 on each side of the center.
3. On the left side, take the strand closest to the center and hold it diagonally down to the left. Tie a diagonal clove hitch with each of the other 5 strands around it.
4. On the right side, do the same, holding the strand closest to the center diagonally down to the right.
5. Repeat with the next strand on each side to make a second diagonal line, and then a third. Each line is a little shorter than the last.
6. Trim all the strands to the shape of a feather, leaving about 3 in (7.5 cm) of fringe and tapering at the tip.
7. Untwist the fringe and comb gently, brushing from the center outward to make it fluffy.

> **Tip**
>
> Spray lightly with water and comb again for an extra soft look. Let it dry before hanging.

Project 12: Mirror Hanger

Two sturdy straps of square knots that hang a light, round mirror with two hanging rings from a dowel.

ITEM	DETAILS
Cord	4 mm cotton rope
Cords to cut	4, plus 1 gathering cord of 24 in (61 cm)
Length of each cord	108 in (3 yd), which is 18 in finished x 6
Working strands	8 (4 cords folded in half), grouped as 2 straps of 4
Other	1 wooden dowel, 8 in (20 cm) long; a lightweight round mirror, up to 12 in (30 cm) wide and under 3 lb (1.4 kg), with two metal hanging rings on the back
Finished size	Each strap about 18 in (46 cm) long
Total cord	456 in (13 yd)

1. Hang the dowel from a hook or cord at chest height.
2. Fold the 4 cords in half and attach each one to the dowel with lark's heads. Make two groups of 2 cords, with 4 in (10 cm) between the groups. You now have 8 strands, 4 in each strap.
3. In each strap, tie a chain of square knots until it measures 14 in (36 cm). At about 3/4 in (2 cm) per knot, that is about 19 knots.
4. Pass the 4 strands of each strap through the mirror's hanging ring, folding the chain back on itself so a loop forms.
5. Gather the end of each strap against its chain with a gathering knot, using half of the 24 in cord for each. Make about 6 wraps and secure.
6. Trim the tails to 2 in (5 cm), brush out the fringe, and hang the dowel on a secure hook.
7. Check that the mirror hangs level. Adjust the gathering knots as needed.

> **Mirrors are heavy**
>
> Glass mirrors are heavy and can shatter. Use a lightweight acrylic mirror or a small mirror, hang the dowel from a hook rated for well above the weight, and never hang it above a bed, a crib or where people sit. Check cords and knots every month.

6. Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	LIKELY CAUSE	HOW TO FIX IT
Knots look uneven	Tension changes from knot to knot	Pull every knot the same amount. Take a break if your hands are tired.
The piece curves or leans to one side	Always tying the same half of a square knot, or more tension on one side	Alternate the halves in square knots. Pin the piece flat and steam lightly to relax.
Spiral will not twist	Alternating the halves instead of repeating the same one	Repeat only the first half and keep tightening.
Cords run out before the end	Cord was cut too short for the number of knots	Use the 4x to 8x rule next time. To save a piece, join a new cord with an overhand knot hidden at the back.
Dowel is not level	Hanging cord not centered or cords hung unevenly	Move the hanging cord until the dowel sits level, or untie and retie.
Fringe is messy	Cutting with dull scissors or brushing too hard	Use sharp scissors and comb gently from the tips up.
Knots slip	Smooth cord or loose tension	Use a rougher cord or pull the knots snug. Add a tiny drop of fabric glue inside a knot if needed.
Gaps between knots	Not pushing knots up before tightening	Slide each knot up against the one above before you pull tight.
Cords tangled	Long cords hanging free	Wrap each cord into a butterfly bundle and unwrap as you need more.
Piece hangs crooked	Uneven cord lengths	Measure each cord before cutting and check lengths before you start.

7. Design Tips: Tension, Symmetry and Spacing

Tension

Even tension is the single biggest factor in a polished piece. Pull each knot with the same force. If a knot is too loose, the pattern sags; if it is too tight, the piece puckers. A good test is to tie three knots in a row and compare them. If they look the same, you are on track.

Symmetry

Mirror your pattern from the center. Count your cords before you start each row and mark the center with a clip or a piece of tape. When you make a V-shaped fringe or a diamond, measure from the center outward.

Spacing

Use a ruler to mark the distance between rows. A gap of 1/4 to 1/2 inch (6 to 12 mm) gives an open, airy look; no gap gives a dense, fabric-like look. Mix the two for more texture.

- Start with a simple pattern and add detail as your confidence grows.
- Limit yourself to two or three colors, or use one color in different thicknesses.
- Add beads sparingly: one or two well-placed beads look better than many.
- Hang the piece on a plain wall so the knots stand out.
- Look at your work from several steps back. Small mistakes disappear, and the shape is easier to judge.

8. Care and Cleaning

- **Dusting:** brush lightly with a soft brush or use a hair dryer on a cool setting, held at a distance.
- **Washing:** handwash in cool water with mild soap, rinse well and gently press out the water. Do not wring or twist.
- **Drying:** lay flat on a clean towel, away from direct heat and sunlight. Reshape and comb the fringe while it is slightly damp.
- **Storage:** hang or store flat in a cotton bag. Keep away from moisture to prevent mildew.
- **Plant hangers:** check the cords every few weeks for wear and sun damage, and replace the hanger if the cord is fraying.

> **Inspect regularly**
>
> Before reusing any hanging piece, check the cord, knots, hooks and anchors for wear. Replace anything that looks weak.

BEFORE YOU HANG A PIECE

☐ Cord and knots checked for wear

☐ Hook or anchor rated well above the weight

☐ Anchored into a stud or with a proper wall anchor

☐ Piece hangs level and the dowel cannot slide

☐ Plants and mirrors hung away from seating and sleeping areas

☐ Small parts and beads checked and out of reach of small children and pets

If you sell what you make, check the rules of the market or craft fair where you sell.

9. Next step

Choose one project from this guide and cut the cords today. Start with the keychain or the coaster if you are new to macrame, or the small wall hanging if you are ready for a bigger challenge. Practice the square knot on scrap cord for ten minutes before you begin, then take your time with each row. Every piece you finish will

make the next one easier. When your first project is hanging on your wall, pick the next one from the list and keep going.